FUNDA AI LITERACY INITIATIVE

AI Literacy Landscape Report

Understanding the global AI literacy landscape before we build — what exists, what works, what's missing, and where Funda fits.

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SECTION 1

Executive Summary

The global AI literacy market has exploded — hundreds of courses, dozens of bootcamps, billions of dollars in corporate training spend. Yet almost none of it was built for African professionals. What exists in Africa is either tool tutorials repackaged with local branding, or developer-track programs for engineers. The gap isn't in volume — it's in depth, context, and philosophy.

This report synthesizes research across five areas: the global program landscape, Africa-specific initiatives, the AI tools landscape, instructional design methodology, and evidence on what works in adult tech literacy. Together, they answer the questions Funda needs to answer before building anything.

> **The core finding:**
>
> The market teaches people to use specific tools. Nobody is teaching people to think well about AI — to choose the right tool, evaluate outputs critically, identify failure modes, and stay in control of AI-assisted decisions. That's Funda's lane.

AFRICA PROGRAMS

ALX has trained 285,000+ learners. AiAfrica targets 11M by 2028. But most programs are developer-track or tool tutorials — not critical AI literacy for working professionals.

GLOBAL PROGRAMS

Google, IBM, Microsoft, Coursera, DeepLearning.AI all have courses. 1.8M people have taken Finland's free Elements of AI. Quality varies wildly — most are tool tutorials.

TOOLS EXPLOSION

200+ significant AI tools across 12+ categories. Tools shift every 6 months. Teaching specific tools is therefore the wrong strategy — teach the framework for choosing.

TRAINING ROI

Organizations with formal AI upskilling report 2× higher AI ROI. Average 340% return within 18 months. Employers pay — this validates the B2B model directly.

SECTION 2

Framing: How We're Approaching This (ADDIE)

Professional course developers use a framework called **ADDIE** — the industry standard for instructional design. It stands for five phases that happen in sequence:

A	D	D	I	E
ANALYSIS	DESIGN	DEVELOP	IMPLEMENT	EVALUATE

We are currently in **Phase 1: Analysis** — the phase where you understand the landscape before designing anything. This document is the output of that phase.

Phase	What It Produces	Status for Funda
Analysis	Needs Analysis Report — learner profile, landscape, gaps, implications	In Progress
Design	Learning Design Brief — objectives, structure, pedagogy, assessment strategy	Not Started
Develop	Actual course content — modules, exercises, materials, facilitator guides	Not Started
Implement	Pilot delivery — run it with real learners, gather feedback	Not Started
Evaluate	Effectiveness measurement — did learners actually get better?	Not Started

Why not a Project Charter / PID instead?

A Project Charter is a project management document — it answers "what are we building, who's responsible, what are the risks." ADDIE is an instructional design process — it answers "how do we build something that actually works for learners." For Funda, we need both: the Learning Design Brief (from ADDIE Design phase) is the course-specific scoping document; a separate Project Charter covers the business and delivery side. This report feeds both.

SECTION 3

The Global AI Literacy Landscape

3.1 Major Programs and Providers

Provider	Program	Audience	Cost	What It Teaches
Google	AI Essentials	All levels, non-technical	Free (cert paid)	AI fundamentals, Gemini tools, responsible AI basics
IBM	AI Fundamentals + Generative AI Professional Certificate	Beginners to practitioners	Free audit / paid cert	GenAI foundations, ChatGPT, responsible AI, LLM application
Microsoft	AI Skills Challenge + Copilot training	Enterprise employees	Free	Microsoft AI tools (Copilot), productivity integration
DeepLearning.AI	Multiple short courses	Developers + practitioners	Paid	Prompt engineering, LLM building, RAG, agents
University of Helsinki	Elements of AI	General public	Free	How AI works conceptually, social implications, no coding
Coursera / various	300+ AI courses	Varies widely	Free audit / paid cert	Full spectrum from literacy to engineering
LinkedIn Learning	AI for Business series	Working professionals	Subscription	Tool overviews, productivity use cases, AI strategy
Udemy / Zero To Mastery	"30-day" bootcamps	Self-directed learners	Low cost ($10–30)	Specific tools: ChatGPT, LLMs, prompt engineering, Cursor, etc.

3.2 The Bootcamp Pattern — What Thando Is Seeing in Her Feed

The "30-day AI challenge" format flooding social media and course platforms follows a very specific structure. Understanding it explains both the market demand and the gap Funda fills.

> **The bootcamp formula:**
>
> Pick one specific tool (ChatGPT, Claude Code, Canva AI, Midjourney, Cursor). Teach that tool's features. Add a "build X projects" project-based hook. Market with urgency ("learn before everyone else"). Deliver via video + exercises. Offer a certificate. Price at $15–30.

These programs exist because **they sell well**. They answer "how do I use this specific tool?" — which is what learners think they need. The problem: tools change every 6 months. A "ChatGPT Bootcamp from 2023" is already partially obsolete. The learner who finishes it knows that one tool — but when a new tool appears, they have no framework to evaluate it.

3.3 What These Programs Teach vs. What They Don't

What Most Programs Teach	What Almost None Teach
How to use tool X (step by step)	How to decide if tool X is right for your task
Prompt engineering for better outputs	How to verify and critique AI outputs
Features of popular tools	How to identify bias or failure in AI outputs
GenAI text/image generation	When NOT to use AI
AI productivity tricks	Organizational and ethical implications
Technical concepts (LLMs, RAG, agents)	How AI fails — and how to catch it before it matters
Generic, Western-context examples and case studies	Content contextualized for African professional realities and work contexts

3.4 The Gold Standard — Elements of AI

The University of Helsinki's *Elements of AI* is worth studying closely — it has reached 1.8 million learners and is genuinely free with no paywall. Key characteristics that made it successful:

- Conceptual, not tool-based — teaches how AI works, not how to use a specific product
- No coding required — genuinely accessible to non-technical learners
- Available in 25+ languages (explicitly inclusive)
- Interactive exercises that build intuition, not passive video watching
- Translated for national digital literacy initiatives in multiple countries

This is the closest analog to what Funda should be — but it was built for European contexts and doesn't engage with African professional realities at all.

SECTION 4

The Africa-Specific Context

Phase 1 scope note:

Funda's initial market is corporate organizations and government ministries — clients who are investing in staff training. Their employees work in office environments with computers, broadband, and standard tech infrastructure. The mobile-first / low-bandwidth constraints below are *context for future expansion*, not blockers for the MVP. Start focused, then build toward broader access.

4.1 What Currently Exists in Africa

Initiative	Scale	Focus	What It Does Well	Gap
ALX Africa	285,000+ learners, 54 countries	Tech careers, professional skills	Scale, pan-African reach, employment outcomes	Developer/career track — not general AI literacy
AiAfrica Project	2.3M participants, target 11M by 2028	AI skills broadly	Massive reach ambition	Breadth over depth — still largely tool-tutorial oriented
Anthropic × ALX × Rwanda	Hundreds of thousands of learners	AI learning companion (Chidi) in education	National government integration, AI in schools	School-focused, not working professional / corporate context
Microsoft SA AI Skills	Target 1M South Africans by 2026	Microsoft tools AI integration	Scale, free access	Microsoft-stack only, product-led not conceptually deep
Kenya National AI Strategy 2025–2030	National policy	Digital infrastructure, talent, governance	Government mandate for AI literacy	Policy without curriculum — the delivery layer doesn't exist yet
University of Lagos OpenAI Academy	University-level	Capacity building	First on continent	Academic track, not working professional / B2B

4.2 Critical Gaps in the African AI Education Landscape

PHASE 2 OPPORTUNITY: MOBILE ACCESS

Only 36% of Africans have broadband. Mobile internet reached 46% of Sub-Saharan Africa in 2023. Phase 1 corporate/gov clients are in offices with good connectivity — but no program has yet built AI literacy for mobile, low-bandwidth access. That's a Phase 2 opening Funda should design toward from the start.

NO AFRICAN-CONTEXT CASE STUDIES

Only 0.2% of AI training data comes from Africa and South America. Courses use US/European examples. A government ministry official in Zimbabwe learning AI has no relevant cases to learn from — until Funda builds them.

NO B2B CORPORATE TRACK

African companies deploying AI tools have no structured training for their staff. The corporate L&D gap is completely unaddressed — ALX targets individuals, not organizations. This is the highest-value, most underdeveloped segment.

NO CRITICAL AI LITERACY

Programs teach tool use, not AI critique. No African program currently teaches professionals to evaluate AI outputs, identify bias, or make informed decisions about AI adoption in their organizational context.

4.3 Infrastructure Context — Relevant for Future Expansion

Phase 1 corporate and government clients operate in office environments — this section is not a current constraint, but it shapes how Funda designs for scalability. Build the MVP so expansion doesn't require rebuilding from scratch.

- **Data costs (future):** Mobile data in sub-Saharan Africa is among the most expensive globally relative to income. When expanding to public access, video-heavy courses will exclude many learners — design content so it can be lightened later.
- **Connectivity (future):** Outside major cities, intermittent connection is the norm. The corporate/gov Phase 1 audience largely sits in well-connected offices — but expansion beyond that requires offline-capable content.
- **Device reality (future):** Broader public access eventually means mobile. Phase 1 can be desktop-first, but content structure should not depend on features that break on mobile.
- **Language (both phases):** English is the working language for most Phase 1 corporate/gov clients. Francophone and Lusophone markets are expansion opportunities — even Phase 1 content should be translation-ready.

SECTION 5

The AI Tools Landscape — Taxonomy & the Overwhelm Problem

There are now over 200 significant AI tools. New ones launch weekly. Teaching any specific tool is therefore a losing strategy — what you teach today may be obsolete in 12 months. **The right approach is to teach the taxonomy and the decision framework, then use tools as examples.**

5.1 The Complete AI Tools Taxonomy (2026)

Category	What It Does	Major Examples	When to Use
Conversational AI / Chatbots	Text dialogue, reasoning, Q&A, brainstorming	ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Copilot, Grok	Thinking partner, drafting, explaining, summarizing
Writing & Content	Generate, edit, rewrite text at scale	Jasper, Writesonic, Copy.ai, Notion AI	Marketing copy, reports, social media, proposals
Image Generation	Create images from text prompts	Midjourney, DALL·E 3, Stable Diffusion, Ideogram, Canva AI	Visuals, presentations, design concepts, social media
Video Generation	Create or edit video from text/images	Sora, Veo 3, Runway, Kling, Pika, Vidnoz	Marketing, training materials, explainers
Audio & Voice	Generate speech, music, voice cloning	ElevenLabs, Suno, Udio, Murf, Nova Sonic	Voiceovers, podcasts, multilingual content
Coding & Development	Write, debug, refactor, review code	GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Claude Code, Tabnine, Replit AI	Software development, automation scripts, data pipelines
Productivity & Automation	Integrate AI into workflows, automate tasks	Notion AI, MS Copilot, Google Workspace AI, Zapier AI	Email, documents, scheduling, repetitive task automation
Research & Knowledge	Search, synthesize, cite information	Perplexity, Consensus, Elicit, Google NotebookLM	Literature reviews, market research, fact-checking
Meeting & Notes	Transcribe, summarize, extract action items	Otter.ai, Fireflies, Granola, Zoom AI	Meeting notes, decisions log, follow-up tracking
Data & Analysis	Analyze data, generate insights, visualize	Julius, ChatGPT Data Analysis, Tableau Pulse	Business reporting, trend analysis, non-coder data work
Agents & Workflows	Multi-step autonomous task execution	n8n, Make, Zapier Agents, CrewAI, AutoGPT	Complex automated workflows, multi-tool orchestration
Presentation & Design	Build slide decks, design assets	Canva AI, Gamma, Beautiful.ai, Tome	Presentations, proposals, visual communications

5.2 The Right-Tool-for-Task Framework

Rather than memorizing tools, Funda graduates should internalize this decision logic:

> **Step 1 — Define the task clearly.**
>
> What exactly am I trying to produce? (A draft? An image? A decision? An analysis?) Vague tasks produce bad tool choices.
>
> **Step 2 — Identify the task category.**
>
> Is this a writing task? A visual task? A research task? An automation task? Each category has an appropriate tool class.
>
> **Step 3 — Choose from the right category.**
>
> Don't use a coding assistant to write a report. Don't use a chatbot to generate images. Match tool to task class first.
>
> **Step 4 — Evaluate the output, not just the tool.**
>
> The best tool for the task still needs your judgment. Is this accurate? Is it complete? Is it appropriate for my audience and context?
>
> **Step 5 — Know when to stop.**
>
> Some tasks — judgment calls, relationship-sensitive decisions, ethically complex situations — should not be delegated to AI regardless of which tool you pick.

5.3 The Tools Explosion — Why It Creates the Demand for Funda

200+ tools, new ones weekly, constant hype cycles, and FOMO-driven bootcamp marketing creates a specific kind of anxiety in working professionals: *"I don't know what I'm supposed to know."*

This is Funda's entry point. The anxiety isn't irrational — there really are a lot of tools. But the solution isn't to learn every tool. It's to have a framework that makes the landscape navigable regardless of what's new. That's what Funda teaches.

SECTION 6

What Works — Evidence from Adult Tech Literacy Research

6.1 From Adult Learning Research

Principle	What It Means for Course Design	Evidence Source
Relevance to daily life is mandatory	Examples and exercises must come from learners' actual work contexts. Abstract examples fail.	National Academies, LINCS
Hands-on practice over passive content	Watching videos doesn't build competence. 70% of learners skip onboarding videos anyway. Learning requires doing.	McKinsey M365 Copilot study
Confidence first, complexity second	Tech anxiety is a real barrier. Early wins that feel achievable reduce resistance. Start with success, add nuance.	Ireland digital literacy study, 2025
Social and peer learning drives adoption	Colleagues explaining AI in job-relevant terms outperform formal training videos. Peer learning hubs matter.	McKinsey, Correlation One
Change management, not just training	Corporate AI adoption requires addressing mindset and culture, not just skill. Training without change management fails.	McKinsey, DataSociety
Emotional and cognitive dimensions matter	Tech literacy isn't only technical. Fear, identity, and self-efficacy all affect outcomes.	arxiv 2502.10166

6.2 What Works Specifically in Corporate AI Training

- **Personalized, adaptive paths:** All-employees training that ignores role-specific context fails. Marketing staff and operations staff need different AI applications.
- **Manager capability is the multiplier:** When managers understand AI and can coach their teams, adoption accelerates. Manager training is higher ROI than individual contributor training alone.
- **Experiential over instructional:** "I like that you have to poke around" — experiential approaches that spark inquiry outperform lecture-based AI literacy instruction.
- **Ongoing support, not one-shot training:** A single 2-day workshop doesn't change behavior. Sustained engagement, check-ins, and peer learning loops do.
- **ROI is measurable:** Organizations with mature AI upskilling report 340% return within 18 months, 30–60 minutes saved per employee per day. This is real and quantifiable — critical for selling to corporates.

6.3 The Critical Thinking Gap — The Biggest Finding

Research from the World Economic Forum (2025) and multiple academic studies confirms: **AI literacy as a core competency is about judgment and evaluation, not tool operation.**

> **What this means for Funda:**
>
> The differentiator isn't teaching more tools — it's teaching the human skills AI can't replicate: evaluating outputs, identifying bias, deciding when not to use AI, and maintaining judgment in AI-assisted workflows. That's what makes a Funda graduate genuinely more capable, not just certified.

SECTION 7

What Funda Must Teach — Curriculum Implications

7.1 The Non-Negotiables (Based on Research)

Competency	Why It Must Be Included	Bloom's Level
What AI is — and what it isn't	Misconceptions drive both fear and over-trust. Getting this right is the foundation for everything else.	Understand
The AI tools taxonomy — navigating the landscape	Tools change. The framework for choosing doesn't. Teach the map, not the specific destinations.	Apply
Evaluating AI outputs critically	Hallucination, bias, incompleteness. The most important skill — and the most ignored by competitors.	Evaluate
When to use AI vs. when not to	Inappropriate AI use creates risk. Learners need principled judgment, not just enthusiasm.	Evaluate / Analyze
Prompt engineering for real tasks	Getting better outputs from tools people already use. Immediate practical value.	Apply
AI ethics in professional context	Bias, privacy, data governance. African professionals face these in real deployments — need frameworks.	Evaluate
AI in your specific domain	Relevance is the #1 factor in adult learning effectiveness. Generic training fails. Sector-specific wins.	Apply / Create

7.2 What to Leave Out (Scope Guard)

- **How to build AI systems** — that's developer training. Funda is for professionals who use AI, not build it.
- **Deep technical explanations** — LLM architecture, transformer mechanics, training data pipelines. Not relevant to our learner.
- **Single-tool deep dives** — "30 days of ChatGPT" is the competitor, not the template.
- **Completion certificates with no competency backing** — a certificate that just means "you watched all the videos" adds no value. What to avoid is the credential factory model, not certificates themselves (see 7.3).

7.3 Certification — Yes, But Tied to Competency

Funda should offer a certificate of completion. People want proof they did something — it drives enrollment, supports professional development requirements, and gives learners something to share. Certificates are not the problem; empty certificates are.

> **The Funda certificate should mean something:**
>
> Tie it to demonstrated competency — a short assessment, a practical exercise, or a reflection task — not just attendance or video completion. That way, when a learner shares their certificate, it carries weight. Credential credibility builds over time as more Funda graduates prove their capability in real work contexts.

Practically, this means:

- Each module or the final core track assessment includes a competency check (not just a multiple-choice quiz)
- Certificates are branded Funda — as the program builds reputation, so does the certificate's value
- Future goal: pursue recognition from professional bodies or government ministries so the certificate carries formal weight — but that's a Phase 2+ credentialing strategy, not an MVP blocker
- Even without external validation today, a Funda certificate from an African-built, African-contextualized program will be distinctive — nothing else looks like it

SECTION 8

Where Funda Fits — The Differentiated Position

Based on the research, here is Funda's position in the landscape. Note the Phase 1 / Phase 2 distinction — some differentiators are MVP priorities, others are expansion goals.

Dimension	Existing Programs	Funda — Phase 1 (MVP)	Funda — Phase 2 (Expansion)
Content approach	Tool tutorials, feature walkthroughs	Framework thinking + critical evaluation	Same, deeper sector specialization
Audience	Global (US/Europe default), individuals	Corporate + gov staff in Africa (B2B contracts)	Broader African professionals, public access
Infrastructure	Desktop-first, always-on internet assumed	Desktop/laptop, office broadband — same as competitors, but African context	Mobile-first, low-bandwidth, offline-capable
Context	Generic, Western professional contexts	African corporate/gov case studies, local work realities	Community, rural, and multilingual contexts
Philosophy	Banking model — fill learners with content	Problem-posing (Freire) — start from learner questions	Same
Revenue model	Individual subscriptions, certifications	B2B corporate and government training contracts	B2B + individual / public access tier
Depth	Breadth over depth (tool catalogues)	Depth over breadth — one excellent core track	Core track + multiple sector-specialized tracks
Inclusion	Default male, urban, high-literacy	Gender equity built in from design — even in corporate contexts	Full inclusion design: women, rural, lower prior digital exposure

Funda's unique value proposition (Phase 1):

The only AI literacy program purpose-built for African corporate and government professionals — rooted in African work contexts, teaching judgment and critical evaluation rather than tool tutorials, delivered through B2B partnerships with companies and ministries investing in their people.

SECTION 9

Open Questions — What We Still Need to Validate

The Analysis phase doesn't end with research. Before moving to Design, there are questions that need answers from real people — potential learners, potential corporate buyers, and subject matter experts. These are the questions for the next phase of work.

9.1 Learner-Side Questions (Need Primary Research)

- What AI tools are African working professionals already using (or trying to use) today?
- What specific problems are they hitting that they think AI could solve?
- What are their biggest fears or hesitations about AI?
- How do they currently learn new professional skills? (Formal training? YouTube? Colleagues?)
- What languages do they work and learn in?
- What devices do they primarily use for learning outside of work?

9.2 Buyer-Side Questions (Need Corporate/Gov Conversations)

- What is a company or government ministry currently spending on AI training (if anything)?
- What would make them buy an AI literacy program from Funda instead of Microsoft or Google?
- What does "success" look like for an L&D buyer — is it completion rates, behavior change, productivity metrics?
- How do procurement decisions work for training programs in target markets?
- What sectors have the most active AI adoption and therefore the most urgent training need?

9.3 Competitive Intelligence Questions

- Is anyone working on the B2B African AI literacy market that we haven't found yet?
- What have ALX and AiAfrica explicitly avoided — and why?
- Are there African-built AI literacy programs in languages other than English that we missed?

9.4 Design Decisions Still Open

- What is the minimum viable course — the single module that proves the model?
- Should the core track be self-paced, facilitated, or blended?
- What sectors should the first specialized track serve? (Government? Finance? NGO? Healthcare?)
- Should Funda build its own web platform or deliver through an existing LMS (Teachable, Thinkific, Moodle, custom)?
- What does the certificate look like — digital badge, PDF, verifiable credential? What platform supports this?

SECTION 10

Next Steps — Moving to ADDIE Design Phase

The Analysis phase has established the landscape. Here is the recommended sequence before the Design phase can begin:

#	Action	What It Produces	Priority
1	Conduct 5–8 interviews with target learners (African working professionals in corporate or government roles)	Validated learner profile with real job contexts, frustrations, and learning habits	High — gates Design phase
2	Conduct 3–4 conversations with potential B2B buyers (HR/L&D leads at African companies)	Validated buying signals, pricing benchmarks, decision-making context	High — validates business model
3	Identify one pilot organization to design with	Real constraints, real learners, real feedback. A design partner, not just a customer.	High — de-risks everything downstream
4	Study Elements of AI methodology in depth	Detailed analysis of what made it work — interaction design, content structure, assessment	Medium — informs Design phase
5	Competitive analysis of 3–4 African programs (ALX, AiAfrica, any others found)	What they teach, how they teach it, what they've tried and dropped	Medium — prevents duplicating efforts
6	Define the Learning Design Brief	The ADDIE Design phase deliverable: audience profile, learning objectives, module structure, pedagogy, assessment, constraints	Follows steps 1–3

The most important thing right now:

Talk to real people before designing anything. All of this research is secondary — it tells us what's possible and what exists. Only learner and buyer conversations tell us what Funda specifically needs to be. Step 1 and Step 2 above unlock everything else.

This document is the output of ADDIE Phase 1: Analysis. It feeds the Learning Design Brief (Phase 2: Design).